

TAB 26



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-059-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/11/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Gonez - Opposing Federal Funding Cuts That Will Harm Students and Families (Res-059-24/25) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Our nation's public schools serve an essential purpose and role in providing a free education to all children, creating a healthy and supportive environment for students, and preparing those enrolled to be successful and productive members of society;

Whereas, Providing federal funding for our nation's children and the elementary and secondary schools that serve them is one of the most important functions of Congress;

Whereas, The federal funding provided by Congress targets our nation's most vulnerable children to ensure that all students have an equal opportunity to learn, thrive, and reach their full potential;

Whereas, Our public schools rely on the federal funding we receive to provide vital and essential educational, nutritional, and basic health services to all students, particularly those with the greatest needs, including students from low-income families, English language learners, and students with disabilities;

Whereas, Federal Medicaid funding plays a crucial role in supporting our public schools and the well-being of our children by assisting with a portion of the cost of providing basic health services to eligible children from low-income families and assisting with the cost of providing education-related services like speech therapy and physical therapy for eligible students with disabilities;

Whereas, Federal Child Nutrition Programs provide reimbursements to school districts for serving nutritious meals in schools and ensuring all children are ready to learn;

Whereas, Federal funding under the Elementary and Secondary Education Act (ESSA) helps school districts provide essential instructional services, including Title I grants to help low-income students and schools in the poorest neighborhoods, Title II grants to address teacher shortages and pay for teacher training, and Title III grants to help students learn English;

Whereas, Congressional leaders are considering block granting federal education funding, a practice which historically has been used to reduce federal investments in education, cut funding to beneficiaries, and eliminate targeting to vulnerable populations;

Whereas, The loss of these federal funds would have an enormous impact on all of our nation's elementary and secondary school students, particularly those from low-income families, English language learners, and students with disabilities who attend high-poverty schools that have historically been underfunded; and

Whereas, Budget negotiations over FY 2025 continue, with the U.S Senate and House of Representatives approving budget resolutions in the most recent steps toward passing a final FY 2025 spending bill, where the

full breadth and depth of funding cuts to federal programs meant to support vulnerable students is not yet known but likely to be significant and detrimental; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District (District) opposes education cuts in the FY 2025 spending bill and any subsequent legislative, administrative, or regulatory actions that would reduce funding for TK-12 schools, early childhood education, adult education, and the programs that serve our most vulnerable children and families, and be it finally;

Resolved, That the District calls on members of the U.S. Congress to vote NO on any measure that includes:

- Cuts to Medicaid that will negatively impact basic health and educational services for low-income children and students with disabilities;
- Changes to restrict school meal eligibility under the Child Nutrition Programs;
- Reductions in education funding for TK-12 programs including but not limited to Title I, Title II, and Title III of the ESEA, and funding for programs under the IDEA, Perkins Career Technical Education, Adult Education and Family Literacy, Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act, and federal programs that provide early childhood education and care or;
- Block granting of education funding.